

Weekly journal digest for 2026-05-11 to 2026-05-17

Summary, highlights, collection snapshot, and full curated digest

Summary

weekly brief

COMAP Journal Bot reviewed 320 collected candidates for the 2026-05-11 to 2026-05-17 digest window. After manual relevance filtering, the curated digest keeps 66 papers: 25 new this week, 28 previous-week catch-up items, and 13 late additions.

The week is unusually strong for COMAP: state-media effects on LLM behavior, AI-generated knowledge infrastructures, misinformation sharing cues, military AI governance, public-opinion estimation, electoral reform, embodied political emotion, immigration enforcement, climate conflict, and platform-scale political exposure all appear in the curated set.

- AI and computational social science are anchored by LLM behavior under state media control, Grokipedia versus Wikipedia, LLM-generated social-science data, AI rights, military AI governance, and multilingual survey-response classification.
- Political communication and misinformation remain central, with papers on authority cues, national cues, campaign affect, political identity threats, social media dataveillance, TikTok partisan exposure, disinformation corrections, and DSA research access.
- Governance and institutions show up through electoral reform, regime classification, vote buying, immigration enforcement, climate coalitions, USAID cuts, Amazon dredging governance, global policy citations, and institutional trust.

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29 journal sections

New This Week	Communication Research
New This Week	Political Analysis
New This Week	Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences
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New This Week	Nature
New This Week	Political Communication
New This Week	Nature Communications
New This Week	Nature Machine Intelligence

Previous Week Catch-Up	Communication Methods and Measures
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Late Additions	Science
Late Additions	Nature

Highlights

8 priority papers

Focused on New This Week.

1

State media control shapes LLM behaviour by influencing training data

Nature | 2026-05-13

Why it matters: A direct fit for COMAP's digital authoritarianism and AI agenda: it links state-controlled information environments to measurable shifts in model behavior.

Open article

2	Scientific authority cues increase the spread of misinformation Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences 2026-05-15 Why it matters: This one is useful for misinformation work because it shows how authority signals can unintentionally increase sharing of false claims. Open article
3	Selective divergence between Grokipedia and Wikipedia articles Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences 2026-05-15 Why it matters: A timely comparison of AI-generated and collaboratively edited knowledge infrastructures, with clear implications for platform bias and public knowledge. Open article
4	Improving Small-Area Estimates of Public Opinion by Calibrating to Known Population Quantities Political Analysis 2026-05-15 Why it matters: A practical methods contribution for public-opinion measurement, especially when survey nonresponse and model misspecification threaten subgroup estimates. Open article
5	Attitudes Toward Electoral System Reform and Party System Change in the U.S. American Political Science Review 2026-05-14 Why it matters: The paper gives experimental evidence on how Americans evaluate alternative electoral systems and their party-system consequences. Open article
6	Educational policies can strengthen climate coalitions Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences 2026-05-14 Why it matters: This is a strong climate-politics keep: it asks how policy design can build broader support for decarbonization coalitions. Open article

7

Re-thinking human-machine interaction and the governance of AI in the military domain

Nature Machine Intelligence | 2026-05-11

Why it matters: A governance-focused AI paper that connects human-machine interaction to high-stakes institutional and military settings.

Open article

8

Politics embodied: How politics shapes and is shaped by the bodily experience of emotions

Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences | 2026-05-11

Why it matters: It extends political communication and behavior research by connecting political emotion to embodied experience and polarization.

Open article

Collection Snapshot		collected vs curated
Total collected candidates:	320	
New This Week candidates:	160	
Previous Week Catch-Up candidates:	129	
Late Additions candidates:	31	
Curated digest below:	25 new, 28 catch-up, 13 late additions	
Note:	The full collected set above is before manual relevance filtering, while the HTML email body and attached PDF reflect the curated digest.	

Full Curated Digest		66 papers
New This Week		25 papers / 10 journals
Communication Research		1 paper

The Effects of Individual Coping, Communal Coping, and Person-Centered Support on Depression Management

2026-05-15 | Xi Tian; Erin Basinger

Affiliations: University of Delaware, Newark, USA; University of North Carolina at Charlotte, USA

DOI: 10.1177/00936502261452885

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: This study compared individual and communal coping messages to highly person-centered support in the context of depression management within romantic relationships. The sample included 138 adults who had been diagnosed with depression, and they evaluated messages that were manipulated to vary in coping strategies and person-centeredness. Results showed that communal coping messages led to greater emotional improvement than individual coping and highly person-centered messages through an indirect effect conveyed by increased perceptions of joint efforts between partners. Cognitive reappraisal, relational connectedness, and shared appraisal did not significantly mediate the relationships between message features and emotional improvement. In addition, highly person-centered messages corresponded with more emotional improvement than individual coping messages. The discussion highlights the implications of partners' coping-oriented versus supportive approaches to depression management.

Political Analysis

1 paper

Improving Small-Area Estimates of Public Opinion by Calibrating to Known Population Quantities

2026-05-15 | William Marble; Joshua D. Clinton

Affiliations: Stanford University; Vanderbilt University

DOI: 10.1017/pan.2026.10044

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Abstract Multilevel regression and poststratification (MRP) is widely used to estimate opinion in small subgroups and to adjust unrepresentative surveys. Yet, even flexible MRP models contain errors generated by non-response and model misspecification. We propose a principled, data-driven method to leverage observable errors on auxiliary quantities with known marginal distributions—for example, election outcomes—to improve estimates of policy attitudes. Our method leverages the correlation between auxiliary variables and outcomes of interest to calibrate MRP estimates to these known marginal distributions. We illustrate our approach using a pre-election poll measuring support for an abortion referendum. We find that the method reduces county-level error by nearly two-thirds relative to traditional MRP. We also show how our calibration approach can be used to generate estimates for smaller nested geographies, such as precincts, even in the absence of poststratification data at this level. Our approach provides a framework for fully incorporating known population data to improve estimates of public opinion in small subgroups, providing scholars another tool to study representation.

Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences

10 papers

Scientific authority cues increase the spread of misinformation

2026-05-15 | Ismail Harrando; Rodrigo Reyes Cordova; Achim Edelman

Affiliations: Medialab, Sciences Po

DOI: 10.1073/pnas.2535823123

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Despite extensive efforts to curb misinformation, it continues to spread on social media platforms. Research indicates that people rarely share content they know is false, rather, they do so unintentionally due to cognitive biases triggered by contextual cues. Combining a large-scale behavioral data analysis with an experimental study, we investigate how Scientific Authority Cues, which we define as mentions of entities that signal scientific expertise or findings, affect the sharing of fact-checked content on social media by granting it credibility. Analyzing 8.7 million tweets linking to fact-checked content shared on Twitter (now X) between 2010 and 2023, we find that tweets with such cues are shared more, especially when linking to low veracity content or posted by right-leaning users. In a preregistered experiment deployed to U.S. participants (N = 1,187), headlines that attributed claims to scientific entities elicited a greater willingness to share, an effect statistically mediated by perceived accuracy and influenced by trust and familiarity. Together, these findings reveal the double edge of invoking scientific authority: In polarized online spaces, cues that signal scientific credibility can be co-opted to amplify misinformation.

Selective divergence between Grokipedia and Wikipedia articles

2026-05-15 | Saeedeh Mohammadi; Taha Yasseri

Affiliations: Centre for Sociology of Humans and Machines; School of Mathematics and Statistics; Trinity College Dublin and Technological University Dublin; University College Dublin

DOI: 10.1073/pnas.2603294123

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: The launch of Grokipedia, an AI-generated encyclopedia developed by xAI, was presented as a response to perceived ideological and structural biases in Wikipedia, with the goal of producing more "truthful" entries using the Grok large language model. However, whether such an AI-driven alternative can systematically correct the biases and limitations of human-edited platforms remains unclear. Here we conduct a large-scale computational comparison of 17,790 matched article pairs drawn from the 20,000 most-edited English Wikipedia pages. We find that Grokipedia pages are longer, more syntactically complex, and contain fewer references per word. Similarity measures across the two platforms reveal a bimodal structure: many Grokipedia articles closely resemble their Wikipedia counterparts, while a considerable subset diverges. Political bias differences emerge primarily within the divergent subset, where Grokipedia shows a relative rightward shift in the ideological orientation of frequently cited news media sources, particularly in articles related to religion and history. These patterns indicate selective, topic-specific divergence rather than a uniform debiasing of Wikipedia content. More broadly, AI-generated encyclopedias may depart from established editorial norms by favoring narrative expansion over citation-based verification, raising questions about transparency, provenance, and the governance of knowledge in automated information systems.

The pig in the python: US decennial labor flows and economic opportunity, 1910-2040

2026-05-15 | Steven Ruggles

Affiliations: Department of History, University of Minnesota; Institute for Social Research and Data Innovation, University of Minnesota

DOI: 10.1073/pnas.2601716123

[Link: Open article](#)

Abstract: This analysis revisits the relative cohort size hypothesis proposed by demographer Richard Easterlin in the 1960s. Easterlin argued that the economic and social prospects of a generation are influenced by the size of the cohort relative to adjacent cohorts. He hypothesized that relative cohort size affects wages, employment, marriage, and fertility decisions. The theory fits the data well for the period from 1940 to 1980 but fails in later decades. I present a more nuanced view of the impact of demographic factors on worker competition through the lens of a measure of decennial labor-force flows. This approach allows consideration of the effects of retirement, female labor-force participation, and immigration on labor-market competition. I calculate these flows for the period from 1910 to 2040 and propose an index of employment competition. The results show that trends in labor-market competition are consistent with wage trends of young workers since 1940. Projections to 2040 show that we are on the verge of a radical reshaping of labor markets in which new workers will be in extremely short supply.

Educational policies can strengthen climate coalitions

2026-05-14 | Max Bradley; Rens Chazottes; Susanna Garside; Nina Lopez-Uroz

Affiliations: Department of Political and Social Sciences, European University Institute; Department of Politics and International Relations, University of Oxford; Max Planck Institute for the Study of Societies; Swiss Federal Institute of Technology Lausanne

DOI: 10.1073/pnas.2533821123

[Link: Open article](#)

Abstract: Building public support for ambitious climate policies is a central challenge for governments seeking to decarbonize their economies. Many climate change mitigation policies impose visible material costs on citizens, and governments have limited fiscal capacity to deploy compensatory measures. Education is often used as a tool to build public awareness about climate change, but its effect on support for climate policies is not well understood. We evaluate the effects of a climate education policy through the study of a real-world large-scale educational intervention: a 3-h interactive workshop which has so far been implemented in over 500 French universities. We employed a randomized control trial reaching 1,845 students across 167 workshops. Students who took the workshop expressed 7 percentage points higher support for costly climate policies, including a beef tax, short-haul flight ban, and meat-free university canteen, compared with the control group. The workshop increased beliefs in the effectiveness of these policies and elicited more positive emotions about climate action. Evidence from a subsample of follow-up survey respondents suggests these effects may persist for at least 6 wk. We find no evidence that the workshop increases willingness to donate to a climate NGO. Overall, the results suggest that well-designed climate education can play a role in broadening public coalitions for ambitious climate policies by strengthening perceived policy effectiveness and support for costly policies.

Evolution of noisy learning in games

2026-05-12 | Marta C. Couto; Fernando P. Santos; Christian Hilbe

Affiliations: Interdisciplinary Transformation University; Max Planck Research Group on the Dynamics of Social Behavior, Max Planck Institute for Evolutionary Biology; Socially Intelligent Artificial Systems Group, Informatics Institute, University of Amsterdam

DOI: 10.1073/pnas.2529959123

[Link: Open article](#)

Abstract: People make strategic decisions many times a day-during negotiations, when coordinating actions with others, or when choosing partners for cooperation. The resulting dynamics can be studied with learning theory and

evolutionary game theory. These frameworks explore how people adapt their decisions over time, in light of how effective their strategies have been. The outcomes of such learning processes depend on how sensitive individuals are to the performance of their strategies. When they are more sensitive, they systematically favor strategies they deem more successful. When they are less sensitive, their learning process is noisier and more erratic. Traditionally, most models treat this sensitivity as a fixed parameter-like the "selection strength" parameter in evolutionary models. Instead, we study how strategies and sensitivities coevolve. We find that the coevolutionary endpoints depend on both the type of strategic interaction and the learning rule employed. In prisoner's dilemmas, we often observe sensitivities to increase indefinitely. But in snowdrift and stag-hunt games, sensitivities often converge to a finite value, or we observe evolutionary branching altogether. These results shed light on how evolution might shape learning mechanisms for social behavior. They suggest that noisy learning does not need to be a by-product of cognitive constraints. Instead, it can serve as a means to gain strategic advantages.

A multinational megastudy of the effects of gratitude practices on subjective well-being

2026-05-11 | Nicholas A. Coles; Annabel V. Dang; Shigehiro Oishi; Abigail Adade; Aderonke A. Akintola; Beatriz B. de Souza; Biljana Gjoneska; Christine R. Harris; Dev Kesarwani; Dinara Pisareva; Eugene Y. J. Tee; Goo Lyann; et al. (36 total)

Affiliations: Center for Health and Biological Sciences, Mackenzie Presbyterian University; Department of Business, Marketing and Law, University of South-Eastern Norway; Department of Humanities and Social Sciences, Indian Institute of Technology Roorkee; Department of Political Science and Internal Relations, Nazarbayev University; Department of Psychological and Brain Sciences, University of California Santa Barbara; Department of Psychology, Aarhus University; Department of Psychology, Chulalongkorn University; Department of Psychology, Higher Education Learning Philosophy University; et al. (24 total affiliations)

DOI: 10.1073/pnas.2537789123

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Scholars have observed people from a variety of cultures using a variety of gratitude-related practices to change their emotions, outlooks, and social relationships. Across 34 countries purposively sampled to cover a broad set of cross-cultural differences (total N = 10,696), we experimentally tested the effects of 6 brief gratitude interventions on subjective moods, life outlooks, and social evaluations. Compared to 3 control tasks, gratitude practices immediately produced theorized improvements in positive affect ($d = 0.37$), negative affect ($d = 0.22$), optimism ($d = 0.24$), life satisfaction ($d = 0.12$), indebtedness ($d = 0.15$), and envy ($d = 0.16$). Notably, these effects varied across different gratitude practices (0.00 practice country

Discovering regularity and mechanisms of word sense acquisition in childhood

2026-05-11 | Jiangtian Li; Blair C. Armstrong; Yang Xu

Affiliations: 6 King's College Road; Basque Center on Cognition; Cognitive Science Program; Department of Computer Science; Department of Psychology; University of Toronto Scarborough 1265 Military Trail Toronto

DOI: 10.1073/pnas.2525788123

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: How does language use inform the emergence of word meanings in early life? Prior work in developmental psychology and the cognitive sciences typically focuses on studying word acquisition in children without specifying how different senses within a word emerge through time. To shed light on word sense acquisition, we propose a framework grounded in state-of-the-art computational methodologies of contextual word embedding to characterize how different senses of a word unfold as children acquire their lexicon. Our framework identifies word senses automatically by forming semantic clusters through natural language use, and analyzes 1,270 words from approximately 4 million utterances produced by children (19 to 144 mo) and their caretakers. The psychological

validity of these senses was assessed based on a combination of dictionaries, human judgment of semantic similarity, and evaluation from a large language model. We then tested three hypotheses motivated by existing work on word sense emergence in language evolution. First, concrete senses of a word tend to emerge earlier than more abstract senses in child language. Second, word senses grow incrementally in semantic space across development. Third, algorithms of semantic chaining-how words spawn new senses by extending from existing senses-recapitulate the order of word senses in development. We find support for all three hypotheses. Our work suggests that the development of word meaning in language acquisition resembles that in language evolution and offers a converging view on the cognitive principles and mechanisms across timescales in the ontogeny and phylogeny of word sense emergence.

Global and regional climate modes modulate armed conflict risk

2026-05-11 | Tyler E. Bagwell; Sylvia G. Dee; Xinyue Luo; Anna Stravato; Divya Saikumar; Frederi Viens; Bomi K. Lee; Diana Z. O'Brien; Justin S. Mankin

Affiliations: Department of BioSciences, Rice University; Department of Earth, Environmental, and Planetary Sciences, Rice University; Department of English, Rice University; Department of Geography, Dartmouth College; Department of Political Science, Bucknell University; Department of Political Science, Washington University in St. Louis; Department of Statistics, Rice University; Zhejiang Climate Center

DOI: 10.1073/pnas.2532935123

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Because of their impacts on droughts, famines, and floods, modes of climate variability can shape patterns of social instability. Yet the mechanisms linking climate variability to armed conflict remain contested, especially relative to the myriad sociopolitical and economic determinants of conflict. A key challenge is that most studies rely on coarse, state-level data and treat climatic teleconnections as invariant. As such, it is unknown whether there are distinct climate hazards that select for conflict risk; whether conflict scales with climate hazard exposure; and whether such associations exist for more regional forms of climate variability. Here we leverage empirical modeling using a high-resolution gridded dataset of armed conflicts and the natural experiment afforded by two major climate modes-the El Nino-Southern Oscillation (ENSO) and the Indian Ocean Dipole (IOD)-to clarify how systematic hydroclimatic anomalies influence conflict emergence. Our results reveal the following: First, conflict risk heightens during El Nino, but ENSO-associated risk does not scale linearly with teleconnection strength; and, evidence for threshold behavior varies with spatial aggregation. Second, El Nino-related increases in conflict risk arise through its dry teleconnections, with limited evidence for wet teleconnections. Finally, the more regionally confined IOD also influences conflict, with both positive and negative phases elevating risk in strongly teleconnected regions, namely the Horn of Africa and Southeast Asia. These results reveal that modes of climate variability can differentially shape conflict risk, offering insight into societies' vulnerabilities to natural climate fluctuations and, by extension, anthropogenic climate change.

Hard and soft power in immigration enforcement

2026-05-11 | Emily Ryo

Affiliations: Department of Sociology, Duke University; School of Law, Duke University

DOI: 10.1073/pnas.2609140123

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Abstract unavailable.

Politics embodied: How politics shapes and is shaped by the bodily experience of emotions

2026-05-11 | Andrea Vik; Alejandro Galvez-Pol; Sohee Park; Manos Tsakiris

Affiliations: Active Cognition, Embodiment, and Environment Lab, Cognition and Society Research Unit, University of the Balearic Islands; Centre for the Politics of Feelings; Department of Psychology; Department of Psychology, University of the Balearic Islands; Department of Psychology, Vanderbilt University; Royal Holloway, University of London; School of Advanced Study, University of London

DOI: 10.1073/pnas.2534895123

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Political emotions are widely acknowledged as key drivers of political participation and polarization. Yet while it is well established that political emotions matter, far less is known about how they are felt and represented in the body. Across a preregistered, nationally representative study (N = 992), we introduce an embodied approach to political emotion using the validated emBODY-tool, which allows participants to map where in the body they experience sensations when feeling canonical emotions (e.g., anger) and their political counterparts (e.g., "political anger"). Specifically, we address three questions: 1) how political emotions are embodied and differ from their nonpolitical counterparts, 2) whether political dispositions influence how these political emotions are embodied, and 3) how their embodied experience interacts with political dispositions in explaining political attitudes and behavior. Pixelwise bodily sensation maps and aggregated "embodied impact" metrics show that political anger, anxiety, depression, disgust, and hope do not merely mirror their canonical forms, but take on distinct bodily patterns. Political ideology, but not political sophistication, modulates these bodily experiences, with Democrat-leaning participants reporting more intense sensations for negative political emotions, suggesting the presence of "ideological bodies." Crucially, political participation is not explained by how intensely people report feeling emotions, but is instead closely linked to how strongly these emotions are embodied in the body. Together, our findings underscore the body's central role in democratic engagement by showing how political contexts shape embodied emotional experience and how these embodied experiences shape politics and democracy.

American Political Science Review

2 papers

Attitudes Toward Electoral System Reform and Party System Change in the U.S.

2026-05-14 | QUINTON MAYNE; SHANE P. SINGH

Affiliations: Harvard University; University of Georgia

DOI: 10.1017/s0003055426101658

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Electoral reform efforts in the United States are widespread, yet little is known about how Americans evaluate alternative electoral systems or their consequences. We address this gap using conjoint and vignette experiments to study how Americans assess electoral reforms based on their implications for the number of parties and the degree of ideological polarization in the U.S. House of Representatives. Focusing on democratic voice, governability, and responsiveness, our designs emphasize party-system outcomes rather than technical institutional features that may be difficult for citizens to understand. We find that Americans are strongly averse to reforms that generate pronounced legislative polarization, even when it might be expected to enhance democratic voice. Findings pertaining to multipartism are more mixed, with some evidence that respondents respond positively to moderate departures from the two-party system. Perceived gains in voice and responsiveness do not generally compensate for losses in governability, except under arrangements that avoid polarization.

The Politics of Privilege: Discrimination, Monopolized Social Rights, and Reform

2026-05-14 | ANDREW SABL

Affiliations: University of Toronto, Canada

DOI: 10.1017/s0003055426101646

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: This article analyzes three kinds of privilege—roughly, the monopoly or near-monopoly of a prized social good by a group—in terms of the political barriers facing attempts to reform them. Extending previous work, it distinguishes among discrimination privileges, which are zero-sum and relative, benefiting some groups at others' expense; monopolized social right privileges, involving goods enjoyed only by some that can and should be extended to all; and differential treatment privileges, involving disagreement over whether a good currently monopolized by some should be extended to all or to none. The political barriers to reforming discrimination privilege involve group interest; those to reforming monopolized social rights include privilege, ignorance, cost, priorities, policy uncertainty, and the psychological wage. Differential treatment privilege is complicated. An exercise in applied political realism, this article treats normative categories as political inputs rather than philosophical conclusions and seeks to demonstrate the insights enabled by doing so.

Nature Human Behaviour

3 papers

Early-career-researcher-led best practices for social science and behavioural genetics

2026-05-14 | Vincent J. Straub; Nadia V. Harerimana; Lydyia I. A. Alajaasko; Sergio Ordonez Beltran; Asya Bulbul; Tomeu Lopez-Nieto Veitch; Qiyuan Peng; Rossella De Sabbata; Mar Talens

DOI: 10.1038/s41562-026-02469-6

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Abstract unavailable.

The political polarization of health outcomes in the USA

2026-05-14 | Elizabeth Elder; Neil A. O'Brian

DOI: 10.1038/s41562-026-02474-9

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Abstract Public health disparities provide an important lens for understanding social and political change in the USA. Using individual-level medical data and death records, this study shows that conservative Americans experienced worsening health and higher mortality than liberals during the 2010s. Here we find evidence consistent with two potential mechanisms. First, demographic realignment within political coalitions brought less healthy individuals into the conservative camp. Yet by the 2020s, demographic change, public policy and COVID-19 do not fully account for the widening gap in mortality rates. Public opinion data are consistent with a second mechanism: declining trust in medical professionals among right-leaning individuals, including lower willingness to seek care, follow clinical advice or believe in medication effectiveness, even for issues unrelated to COVID-19. These patterns suggest that growing ideological divides in health behaviours are leaving conservative Americans increasingly vulnerable to preventable health risks.

Social functioning in autism: a systematic review and meta-analysis

2026-05-12 | Siyi Li; Huanqing Wang; Guoqiu Chen; Xi Cheng; Yuxi Wang; Wanyan Hu; Antonia Hamilton; Leonhard Schilbach; Li Yi; Kaat Alaerts; Zhanjun Zhang; Xi-Nian Zuo; et al. (14 total)

DOI: 10.1038/s41562-026-02457-w

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Atypical social functioning is a core feature of autism, yet findings remain fragmented across components and development. We aimed to systematically integrate this literature and characterize the organization, development, and moderators of social functioning in autism. We conducted a systematic review and meta-analysis of behavioral studies published between January 1990 and August 2025, identified through PubMed, Web of Science, and prior reviews, including studies with clinically diagnosed autistic individuals and neurotypical controls. A qualitative synthesis and two complementary quantitative meta-analyses were performed, with risk of bias evaluated through study-level characteristics. A total of 2,622 studies (94,114 autistic and 172,847 neurotypical individuals across 32 countries) were included, covering 22 social components that clustered into five domains. Overall group differences were substantial (Hedges' $g = -0.744$, 95% CI $[-0.797, -0.690]$). Differences emerged earliest in motivation-based processes (6 months), followed by motor, emotion, and inference domains, and showed age-related divergence alongside improvement in some skills. Cross-domain analyses revealed stronger interdependencies in autism and an organizational pattern most consistent with serial relationships among domains. These findings should be interpreted in light of methodological heterogeneity, underpowered samples, and uneven cultural representation. Together, the results provide an integrative framework for understanding the organization and development of social functioning in autism, with implications for precision subtyping, developmentally timed interventions, and neurodiversity-informed research and policy. This study was pre-registered (PROSPERO: CRD42024566141).

Science

4 papers

A civic grammar for AI rights

2026-05-14 | Alondra Nelson

Affiliations: Alondra Nelson* is Harold F. Linder Professor of Social Science, and leads the Science, Technology, and Social Values Lab at the Institute for Advanced Study, Princeton, NJ, USA.

DOI: 10.1126/science.aeh7153

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Abstract unavailable.

Aiding peace or conflict? The impact of USAID cuts on violence

2026-05-14 | D. Rohner; U. Sunde; O. Vanden Eynde; A. L. Wright; J.-R. Zeng

Affiliations: Centre for Economic and Policy Research (CEPR), London, UK.; Department of Economics, University of Lausanne, Lausanne, Switzerland.; Department of Economics, University of Munich (LMU), Munich, Germany.; Geneva Graduate Institute, Geneva, Switzerland.; Harris School of Public Policy, The University of Chicago, Chicago, IL, USA.; Humanities and Social Sciences, Centre National de la Recherche Scientifique (CNRS), Paris, France.; Paris School of Economics, Paris, France.

DOI: 10.1126/science.aed6802

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Less than a week after its inauguration, the second Trump administration issued a blanket stop-work order for the United States Agency for International Development (USAID), the largest national humanitarian donor. The social and political effects of abrupt aid withdrawal are poorly understood, especially in fragile states where relief is a key safety net. We provide quasi-experimental evidence on the shutdown's impact on subnational conflict across Africa. Leveraging historical exposure to USAID programs, we show that conflict increased sharply after the shutdown in areas that previously received the most support. The increase spanned incidence and severity, including armed clashes, protests, and riots. The effects appeared immediately and persisted for months. Inclusive local institutions substantially mitigated these harms, underscoring vulnerability under weak governance and the capacity of institutions to buffer humanitarian and economic shocks.

Amazon dredging law exposes governance gaps

2026-05-14 | Stephannie Fernandes; Cecilia Leal; Leandro Castello; Tommaso Giarrizzo; Thiago B. A. Couto

Affiliations: Departamento de Ecologia e Conservacao, Universidade Federal de Lavras, Lavras, Brazil.; Department of Fish And Wildlife Conservation, Virginia Polytechnic Institute and State University, Blacksburg, VA, USA.; Department of Global And Sociocultural Studies, Florida International University, Miami, FL, USA.; Instituto de Ciencias do Mar (LABOMAR), Universidade Federal Do Ceara, Fortaleza, Brazil.; Lancaster Environment Centre, Lancaster University, Lancaster, UK.; School of Environmental Sciences, University of East Anglia, Norwich, UK.

DOI: 10.1126/science.aeg9714

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Abstract unavailable.

Hungary's chance to rebuild science

2026-05-14 | Albert-Laszlo Barabasi

Affiliations: Albert-Laszlo Barabasi is a Distinguished University Professor of Network Science at Northeastern University, Boston, MA, USA and a lecturer at Harvard Medical School, Boston, MA, USA. He is also a visiting professor...

DOI: 10.1126/science.aei5835

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Last month's parliamentary elections ended Prime Minister Viktor Orban's 16-year rule, giving Hungary something more consequential than a change of government: a chance to show the world how to rebuild science after political control. With a two-thirds parliamentary majority, the new leadership has the mandate and the constitutional power to rebuild Hungary's scientific enterprise around merit, and resistance against future interference. If Hungary gets this right, it will offer a model that matters far beyond its borders.

Nature

1 paper

State media control shapes LLM behaviour by influencing training data

2026-05-13

DOI: 10.1038/d41586-026-01486-9

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: State control of the media is shown to alter the training data of large language models (LLMs) through its impact on the information environment. This has a substantial effect on the output of LLMs, with states rated more favourably in their own language when they have tighter media control. States with tight media control are rated more favourably by LLMs when prompted in their own language.

Political Communication

1 paper

How National Cues Polarize Perceptions of Political Figures

2026-05-13 | Joel Sievert; Kevin K. Banda

Affiliations: Texas Tech University

DOI: 10.1080/10584609.2026.2672710

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Abstract unavailable.

Nature Communications

1 paper

Social implications of the 3030 global conservation target

2026-05-12 | Javier Fajardo; Heather C. Bingham; Dan Brockington; Rebecca Chaplin-Kramer; James A. Fitzsimons; Forrest Fleischman; Alain Frechette; Rachael D. Garrett; Carolina Hazin; Tobias Kuemmerle; Janeth Lessmann; Milagre O. F. Nuvunga; et al. (25 total)

DOI: 10.1038/s41467-026-71860-8

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Abstract Target 3 of the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework aims to increase global protected and conserved area coverage to at least 30% by 2030. The impact on people, whether positive or negative, will depend on the social context of additional areas and how they are governed and managed. Here, we show that Target 3 could affect large and socially diverse populations under different implementation scenarios. Nearly half the human population lives within 10 km of areas included in a scenario maximising biodiversity representation. Four percent live near areas included in an Indigenous and traditional territories-based scenario, including many in areas with low Human Development Index scores (74%) and high participation in wild harvesting (91%). A scenario prioritising nature's contributions to people is intermediate on all measures. Our results demonstrate that Target 3 is a highly ambitious social as well as ecological target, requiring an equally ambitious commitment to development funding and support for local residents.

Nature Machine Intelligence

1 paper

Re-thinking human-machine interaction and the governance of AI in the military domain

2026-05-11 | Ingvild Bode; Katherine Chandler

DOI: 10.1038/s42256-026-01231-x

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Abstract unavailable.

Communication Methods and Measures

1 paper

Exploring temporal dynamics in digital trace data: mining user-sequences for communication research

2026-05-09 | Yangliu Fan; Jakob Ohme; Lion Wedel

Affiliations: Institute for Media and Communication Studies, Freie Universitat Berlin; Weizenbaum Institute**DOI:** 10.1080/19312458.2026.2664873**Link:** Open article

Abstract: Communication is commonly considered a process that is dynamically situated in a temporal context. However, there remains a disconnection between such theoretical dynamicality and the non-dynamical character of communication scholars' preferred methodologies. In this paper,...

Communication Research

5 papers

A Longitudinal and Dyadic Study of Communal Coping and Relational Turbulence Among Surviving Parents and Emerging Adult Children After the Death of a Partner/Parent

2026-05-09 | Hannah E. Jones; Jennifer A. Theiss

Affiliations: Rutgers University, New Brunswick, NJ, USA; University of Kentucky, Lexington, USA**DOI:** 10.1177/00936502261449286**Link:** Open article

Abstract: The death of a parent/partner represents a significant and traumatic transition for surviving families. Guided by relational turbulence theory, this longitudinal and dyadic study examines how relationship characteristics in surviving parent-emerging adult child dyads...

Political Identity Threats on Social Media

2026-05-08 | Daniel S. Lane; Yifei Wang; Alcides Velasquez

Affiliations: University of California, Santa Barbara, USA; University of Kansas, Lawrence, USA**DOI:** 10.1177/00936502261443863**Link:** Open article

Abstract: One appealing explanation for the dismal state of digital politics in the U.S. is that social media offer abundant threats to users' political identities. This paper provides a theoretical and empirical foundation for studying political identity threats on social media. A...

Examining the Effects of Viewing Positive Aging TikTok Videos on Aging Outcomes and Attitudes Among Young, Middle-Aged, and Older Women

2026-05-07 | R. Amanda Cooper; Lexi McNamara; Heather Gahler

Affiliations: University of Connecticut, Storrs, USA; University of Wisconsin La Crosse, USA

DOI: 10.1177/00936502261442688

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: This experiment tests the communicative ecology model of successful aging (CEMSA) to determine how viewing positive aging TikTok videos impacts aging outcomes for young (n = 306), middle-aged (n = 225), and older (n = 233) women. We also extend the CEMSA to include ageism...

Shaping Interpersonal Communication About Persuasive Media Campaigns by Inducing Critical Versus Collective Orientations

2026-05-07 | Shu Scott Li; James Price Dillard

Affiliations: The Pennsylvania State University, University Park, USA; University of Akron, OH, USA

DOI: 10.1177/00936502261441102

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Individuals process persuasive campaign messages intra- and interpersonally with the goal of either accurately evaluating the advocacy or defending against it. In an experiment, messages that argued for reducing consumption of sugar-sweetened beverages were presented to...

Angry and Alerted, Happy and Informed? An Experience Sampling Study on the Relationship Between Sentiment, Affect, and Attention Toward Campaign Communication

2026-05-06 | Lukas P. Otto; Fabian Thomas; Michaela Maier

Affiliations: GESIS - Leibniz Institute for the Social Sciences, Cologne, Germany; RPTU Kaiserslautern Landau, Germany

DOI: 10.1177/00936502261443864

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: This study examines how emotional reactions to campaign communication relate to attentional processes and, ultimately, to general interest in a political campaign. Drawing on appraisal theories of emotion and the broaden-and-build theory, we argue that emotional responses to...

Nature Communications

3 papers

A universal scaling law of intra-urban inequality

2026-05-09 | Conghong Huang; Xiaodan Liu; Shibin Zhang; Zongyang Jin; Nan Xu; Weixin Ou

DOI: 10.1038/s41467-026-73015-1

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Abstract Large-scale urban agglomeration yields economic benefits but often coincides with pronounced environmental and social disparities. While aggregate urban attributes follow predictable scaling laws, how intra-urban inequality scales with city size remains unclear. To...

Proactive collaboration via autonomous interaction

2026-05-09 | Peiyan Li; Shuyuan Zhang; Wenju Yang; Yitong Hu; Yuhang Wang; Dunzheng Wang; Hang Li; Di Guo; Huaping Liu

DOI: 10.1038/s41467-026-72797-8

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Human teams excel at dynamically restructuring both task assignments and team composition in response to emerging challenges, proactively recruiting or releasing members as needed. This capacity for autonomous adaptation is a cornerstone of effective teamwork, yet remains...

Non-cognitive skills mediate education-related polygenic score associations with academic achievement across development

2026-05-08 | Quan Zhou; Wangjingyi Liao; Andrea G. Allegrini; Kaili Rimfeld; Jasmin Wertz; Tim T. Morris; Laurel Raffington; Robert Plomin; Margherita Malanchini

DOI: 10.1038/s41467-026-72838-2

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Abstract The role of environmental, developmental, and psychological processes in translating genetic dispositions into observed academic achievement remains under-investigated. Here, we examine whether non-cognitive skills-including motivation, attitudes, and emotional and...

Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences

5 papers

Evaluating the statistical realism of LLM-generated social science data

2026-05-08 | Yueqi Xie; Lemeng Liang; Shuzhen Li; Yifu Lu; Zhiwen Xiao; Mengdi Shi; Junming Huang; Mengdi Wang; Yu Xie

Affiliations: Center for Social Research, Guanghua School of Management, Peking University; Department of Electrical & Computer Engineering; Department of Sociology; Paul and Marcia Center on Contemporary China; Princeton University

DOI: 10.1073/pnas.2538145123

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Large language models (LLMs) hold great promise for generating social science data, potentially expanding the methodological toolkit of quantitative social research. Prior studies have primarily focused on individual-level predictability or behavioral plausibility of...

Observational epidemiological studies can mitigate genetic confounding with a genetic relatedness matrix

2026-05-06 | Roshni A. Patel; Joshua G. Schraiber; Matt Pennell; Michael D. Edge

Affiliations: Department of Computational Biology, Cornell University; Department of Data Science, University of Oregon; Department of Quantitative and Computational Biology, University of Southern California; Institute of Ecology and Evolution, University of Oregon

DOI: 10.1073/pnas.2533909123

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Observational studies are commonly used in psychology and epidemiology to identify risk factors correlated with health outcomes. However, these studies are vulnerable to confounding when shared genetic variation influences both the putative risk factor and outcome....

The electoral choice context and support for democratic norms

2026-05-06 | Kang Huang; Mitchell Lovett; Gretchen Helmke

Affiliations: Department of Political Science; Simon Business School; University of Rochester

DOI: 10.1073/pnas.2521380123

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: In this paper, we explore whether different choice environments affect voters' willingness to put democracy over party and policy. Using a series of candidate choice experiments in which we manipulate not only candidate attributes, but also the number of races on the ballot,...

Social cognition and interpersonal violence

2026-05-05 | Megan Kang; Kathryn Edin; Jens Ludwig; Timothy Nelson; Sendhil Mullainathan

Affiliations: Department of Economics, Massachusetts Institute of Technology; Department of Electrical Engineering and Computer Science, Massachusetts Institute of Technology; Department of Sociology and School of Public and International Affairs, Princeton University; Harris School of Public Policy, University of Chicago; National Bureau of Economic Research; School of Government and Policy, Johns Hopkins University

DOI: 10.1073/pnas.2519361123

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Why do some people resort to violence while others in similar circumstances do not? Drawing on 99 in-depth interviews with men from high-violence Chicago neighborhoods who participated in a community violence intervention, we examine how past exposure to violence shapes the...

Social media promotion improves job market outcomes

2026-05-04 | Jingyi Qiu; Yan Chen; Alain Cohn; Alvin E. Roth

Affiliations: Department of Economics, Stanford University; School of Information; University of Michigan

DOI: 10.1073/pnas.2528289123

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Social media has transformed how academics disseminate research, but its effect on academic job outcomes remains unclear. Previous research has shown correlations between social media exposure and metrics like citation counts, but these relationships may be confounded by...

Nature Human Behaviour

3 papers

Government policy documents across 185 countries largely cite Global North sources

2026-05-07 | Sebastian Ramirez-Ruiz; Roman Senninger

DOI: 10.1038/s41562-026-02464-x

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Abstract unavailable.

Population-based RCT of a digital cognitive-behavioural guided self-help intervention for anxiety, depression and eating disorders in college students

2026-05-07 | Michelle G. Newman; Ellen E. Fitzsimmons-Craft; Seung Yeon Baik; Nur Hani Zainal; Adam Calderon; Gavin N. Rackoff; Marie-Laure Firebaugh; Elsa Rojas-Ashe; Yan Leykin; Daphne Lew; Daniel Eisenberg; C. Barr Taylor; et al. (13 total)

DOI: 10.1038/s41562-026-02454-z

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Abstract unavailable.

An individual participant data meta-analysis of how physical activity relates to affective well-being in daily life

2026-05-06 | Johanna Rehder; Irina Timm; Gesa Berretz; Iris Reinhard; Andreas B. Neubauer; Onur Gunturkun; Keisuke Takano; Walter Bierbauer; Miriam Cabrita; Matthew Bourke; Joshua Smyth; Jinhyuk Kim; et al. (68 total)

DOI: 10.1038/s41562-026-02427-2

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Abstract Physical inactivity constitutes a pressing societal problem. To realize physical activity's (PA) potential as a key health resource, mechanisms of PA engagement need to be understood. Laboratory and interventional studies documented that exercise relates to...

Science

2 papers

Arrest of Fauci aide for records violations decried as political

2026-05-07 | Jon Cohen

DOI: 10.1126/science.aei6152

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: David Morens's indictment centers on help he gave nonprofit that funded China research blamed for pandemic

Lessons in resistance from Tim Snyder

2026-05-07 | H. Holden Thorp

Affiliations: H. Holden Thorp is Editor-in-Chief of the Science journals.

DOI: 10.1126/science.aei5187

Link: Open article

Abstract: Federal grant cancellations, restrictions on immigration for foreign scientists, and attempts to cut the budgets of science funding agencies by 60%-the past 18 months have been tumultuous for American science. Even after Congress restored the budgets, following the...

Nature

2 papers

Systematic partisan content skews in TikTok during the 2024 US elections

2026-05-06 | Hazem Ibrahim; HyunSeok Daniel Jang; Nouar Aldahoul; Aaron R. Kaufman; Talal Rahwan; Yasir Zaki

DOI: 10.1038/s41586-026-10447-1

Link: Open article

Abstract: Abstract Social media platforms increasingly mediate political information exposure, yet the role of algorithmic curation in shaping political exposure remains contested 1,2 . This question is difficult to resolve on platforms in which users retain substantial control over...

Precision medicine without equity is just stratified inequality

2026-05-05 | Afsaneh Shirani

DOI: 10.1038/d41586-026-01442-7

Link: Open article

Abstract: Abstract unavailable.

Political Analysis

3 papers

Text as Behavior

2026-05-06 | Omar Wasow

Affiliations: University of California, Berkeley

DOI: 10.1017/pan.2026.10041

Link: Open article

Abstract: Abstract Text analysis typically focuses on content-such as sentiment or topic-but expression is also a form of effortful action. Building on this insight, I propose using simple features of open-ended tasks to study text as

behavior. This approach treats expression, such as...

Democracy Manifest or Democracy Latent? A Unified Framework for Identifying Regime Types and Transitions

2026-05-05 | Omer Faruk Orsun; Muhammet A. Bas

Affiliations: New York University Abu Dhabi

DOI: 10.1017/pan.2026.10042

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Abstract Regime types and transitions are central to a wide range of political phenomena. Reflecting this importance, prior research has produced a variety of regime measures. This diversity, however, comes with important challenges for applied research: selecting a measure...

Using Multilingual Language Technology to Classify Open-Ended Survey Responses: Conceptions of Democracy in a Cross-Cultural Survey Setting

2026-05-04 | Stefan Dahlberg; Luise Durlich; Sofia Axelsson; Yahui Zhao; Joakim Nivre

Affiliations: Centrum voor Wiskunde en Informatica; Mid Sweden University; RISE Research Institutes of Sweden AB; University of Bergen; University of Gothenburg; Uppsala University

DOI: 10.1017/pan.2026.10043

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Abstract Recent advancements in language technology have opened new avenues in political science for automating and improving survey data analysis across diverse cultural contexts. This article examines the effectiveness of language models (LMs) in analyzing open-ended...

American Journal of Political Science

1 paper

Vote buying and negative agenda control: A problem for the study of money in politics

2026-05-05 | Andre Van Parys

Affiliations: Department of Political Science University of Rochester Rochester USA

DOI: 10.1111/ajps.70063

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Abstract Politicians, pundits, and ordinary citizens frequently argue that money has an outsized influence on US politics. Yet research on the effect of money on politicians' behavior finds limited effects, especially on voting behavior. I construct a formal model to show...

American Political Science Review

1 paper

Procedural Polarization: How Election Rules Shape Voters' Confidence

2026-05-05 | JOSHUA D. CLINTON

Affiliations: Vanderbilt University

DOI: 10.1017/s000305542610166x

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Prior research demonstrates voters' confidence in elections depends on whether their preferred candidate wins, but does agreement with the electoral rules being used also matter? Leveraging growing procedural polarization in election laws, public opinion data from 2008 to...

Journal of Communication

1 paper

Dataveillance inhibits legitimate communication: causal evidence for chilling effects

2026-05-05 | Noemi Festic; Moritz Buchi; Michael Latzer; Celine Odermatt

Affiliations: Department of Communication and Media Research, University of Zurich , Zurich,; Institute of Applied Media Studies, ZHAW Zurich University of Applied Sciences , Winterthur,

DOI: 10.1093/joc/jqag004

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Abstract Chilling effects are an undesirable consequence of the datafication of communication: people may refrain from entirely lawful online activities due to fear of negative repercussions based on their digital traces. Our preregistered, longitudinal online field...

Political Communication

1 paper

"Everything for the Front, Everything for Victory"? Elite Incentives and Rhetorical Adaptation of Russia's Members of Parliament on Social Media

2026-05-05 | Nikita Khokhlov; Daniil Romanov; Alexander Batur

Affiliations: Dublin City University; University College Dublin; University of Oxford

DOI: 10.1080/10584609.2026.2664717

Link: [Open article](#)

Abstract: Abstract unavailable.

Late Additions

13 papers / 7 journals

Political Communication

1 paper

Date	Late additions	Link
2026-05-01	What the DSA Means Outside Europe: Research Access and Its Limits Laura Edelson 10.1080/10584609.2026.2665427	Open

Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences

3 papers

Date	Late additions	Link
2026-05-01	An inverse correlation between structural linguistic and human genetic diversity Anna Graff; Erik J. Ringen; Taras Zakharko; Mark Stoneking; Kentaro K. Shimizu; Balthasar Bickel; Chiara Barbieri 10.1073/pnas.2526762123	Open
2026-05-01	Disparate social structures are underpinned by distinct social rules across a primate radiation Jacob A. Feder; Susan C. Alberts; Elizabeth A. Archie; Magorzata E. Arlet; Alice Baniel; Jacinta C. Beehner; Thore J. Bergman; Alecia J. Carter; Marie J. E. Charpentier; Kenneth L. Chiou; Catherine...	Open
2026-05-01	The evolution of trust under institutional moral hazard Hiroaki Chiba-Okabe; Joshua B. Plotkin 10.1073/pnas.2530718123	Open

Science Advances

1 paper

Date	Late additions	Link
2026-05-01	An AI-driven, wearable, conformal ring system for real-time and user-independent sign language interpretation Jaejin Park; Yejee Shin; In Sik Min; Yeeun Lee; Jiwon Lee; Jung-Hoon Hong; Sunho Park; Sang Hoon Park; Junhyeong Baek; Taemin Kim; Kyubeen Kim; Doyun Kim; et al. (20 total) 10.1126/sciadv.aec8995	Open

Communication Research

2 papers

Date	Late additions	Link
2026-04-30	Gains, Limits, and Side-Effects of Disinformation Interventions: Corrective Information and Self-Affirmation Assessed With Signal Detection Theory Luisa Gehle; Christian Schemer 10.1177/00936502261442623	Open
2026-04-29	Theoretical Distinctions Between Emotion and Cognition Content in Supportive Messages: Examining Effects and Mediating Mechanisms Amanda J. Holmstrom; Junwen M. Hu; Samantha J. Shebib; Jong In Lim; Yue Zhang; Andrew Bredland; Allison P. Mazur; Adam J. Mason; Amanda Allard; Josephine K. Boumis; Hailey Schulte; Ji Hyun Ha; et al. (18...	Open

Human Communication Research

1 paper

Date	Late additions	Link
2026-04-30	The invisible labor of assimilation by individuals with stigmatized identities: a qualitative study of autistic workers' organizational socialization Young Ji Kim; Margot Plunkett 10.1093/hcr/hqag002	Open

Science

4 papers

Date	Late additions	Link
2026-04-30	CDC communication undermines trust in vaccines Robert Bohm; Alina Schneider; Cornelia Betsch; Lau Lilleholt 10.1126/science.aef5320	Open
2026-04-30	Disneyland's factory-inspired future Disneyland and the Rise of Automation <i>Roland Betancourt</i> Princeton University Press, 2026. 416 pp. Renee Blackburn 10.1126/science.aef8390	Open
2026-04-30	Peer influence decay and behavioral diffusion in adolescent networks: A simulation approach Cheng Wang; Carter T. Butts; John R. Hipp; Cynthia M. Lakon 10.1126/science.aea9297	Open
2026-04-30	The misinformation accelerator Kai Kupferschmidt 10.1126/science.aei4485	Open

Nature

1 paper

Date	Late additions	Link
2026-04-29	Training language models to be warm can reduce accuracy and increase sycophancy Lujain Ibrahim; Franziska Sofia Hafner; Luc Rocher 10.1038/s41586-026-10410-0	Open

Delivery preferences can be changed in the local recipient configuration.